

THE IDEA

From whiteboard to shared tender workspace

A practical system for discovering opportunities, making review decisions and preparing bids before the deadline.

PLANNED COMPANY ADDRESS

tenders.pumpsystemsafrika.com

One place to see what needs doing

The existing whiteboard becomes a shared, searchable record. Every active tender has an owner, an official closing time, an internal target, preparation tasks and a visible next action.

A clear decision-maker

All staff can use the system through company-email accounts. The **Projects Manager** is assigned the reviewer role and decides whether to pursue, watch or dismiss discovered opportunities.

Discovery without premature exclusions

Collect Zimbabwe procurement opportunities containing the agreed keywords. Rank them by match strength and retain weaker matches for review; do not filter them out based on unconfirmed service or capacity assumptions.

Two outputs, one workflow

PRAZ contains authenticated PRAZ notices. **Private** contains other internet sources, including public-sector notices found elsewhere. Both feed the same review queue and tender workspace.

FIND AND RANK

Daily discovery, with reasons

A transparent match score helps the Projects Manager review the most relevant notices first. It is a relevance ranking, not an eligibility or win probability.

The collection schedule

Run both discovery channels daily at **08:00 CAT / 06:00 UTC**. A **Check now** control requests another scan, prevents overlapping runs and reports completion or failure. Scan failures never appear as "no new tenders".

Notice types to recognise

Tender; invitation to tender (ITT); invitation to bid (ITB); request for quotation (RFQ); request for proposal (RFP); expression of interest (EOI); procurement notice; supplier prequalification and registration notices. Preserve the actual notice type and distinguish early-stage notices from bids.

Proposed score: 0-100

Title match: up to 45 points. Exact approved phrase = 45; keyword or spelling variant = 30.

Scope match: up to 35 points. Procurement requirement containing an approved term = 35; descriptive mention = 20.

Distinct keyword groups: up to 20 points. Two groups = 10; three or more = 20.

Repeated words do not add points. Show the matching passage and score breakdown.

STARTING THRESHOLDS

Strong: 70-100 / Moderate: 40-69 / Weak: 0-39

Keep relevance separate from verification

Retain every keyword-matched candidate. Flag unclear Zimbabwe relevance, missing deadlines, expired notices, inaccessible documents and conflicting dates. Default to active notices, with expired and uncertain records still accessible. These flags do not silently erase keyword matches.

SEARCH VOCABULARY

The agreed keyword coverage

Search notice titles and available document text. Normalise singular/plural forms, spacing and common spelling variants. Read scanned documents where extraction is possible.

Pumps and stations

pump, pumps, pumpstation(s), pump station(s), pumping station, pumping systems, booster, submersible, centrifugal, dosing and dewatering pumps

Solar and boreholes

solar systems, solar grid, solar PV, photovoltaic, off-grid, solar pumping, solarisation/solarization, borehole(s), drilling, equipping, rehabilitation, test pumping

Water infrastructure and treatment

water supply, transfer, abstraction, reticulation, distribution, pipelines, water treatment, purification, filtration, chlorination, chemical dosing, reverse osmosis

Sewage and irrigation

sewage, sewerage, wastewater, waste water, effluent, sludge pumps, lift station, irrigation pumps, irrigation schemes and rehabilitation

Equipment and services

pump repairs, servicing, maintenance, spares, electric motors, control panels, variable frequency drives, VFDs, valves and pipework

Source evidence and duplicates

Prefer the original issuing organisation over an aggregator. Store the original link, reference, issuing entity, first-seen date and last successful check. Merge duplicate notices across PRAZ and Private while retaining every source link. Broad or ambiguous matches stay visible for human review.

PEOPLE AND ACTION

Review, prepare, submit

The Projects Manager owns review decisions. Assigned staff own the preparation work. Discovery emails inform the whole team without creating duplicate tender records.

Review decisions

Pursue: confirm tender details, assign an owner and set an internal target; create a preparation checklist.

Watch: retain the notice for later consideration.

Dismiss: capture a short reason and keep the decision history. Staff can view opportunities; the Projects Manager makes these review decisions.

Manual tender entry

Add tenders received by email, phone, WhatsApp or other channels. Capture title, reference, customer, owner and source; attach documents where available. Missing closing details can remain in review, but deadline reminders require a confirmed date, time and timezone.

Email policy

After each scan, send one digest of **new strong matches to every active registered staff email**. Moderate and weak matches remain on the dashboard. Deduplicate alerts; an opportunity newly promoted to Strong can receive its first strong-match alert. No email is needed when there are no new strong matches.

Active tender reminders

Closing reminders run independently of discovery. Proposed defaults: seven days, three days, one day and two hours before closing. Notify the owner and relevant assignees; escalate overdue work to the Projects Manager. Verified urgent amendments are notified promptly after discovery. Submission evidence stops closing reminders.

The shared record

Store scope, source documents, tasks, comments, review history, approvals and submission evidence. Keep official and internal deadlines separate. Statuses: Reviewing, Preparing, Awaiting approval, Submitted, Won and Lost.

DELIVERY AND DEPENDENCIES

What makes the idea work

The concept website demonstrates the workflow with fictional data. Production services are separate implementation work, not implied by the demo.

A practical production setup

PostgreSQL: tender records, sources, users, roles, tasks, scoring, reviews, scan history and email delivery records.

File storage: documents and submission receipts.

Background worker: scheduled collection, document processing, retries and reminder checks.

Email service: staff discovery digests and tender reminders.

PRAZ connection

Use the company's authorised account through an approved API/feed if available, otherwise permitted authenticated browser access. Store credentials and sessions securely on the server. OTP/CAPTCHA steps require an authorised person; expired sessions trigger reconnection alerts. Browsing does not register participation, pay fees or submit bids.

Private connection

Combine scheduled checks of known Zimbabwe procurement sources with broader web searches. Verify results against source notices; handle paid or authenticated sources separately. Coverage depends on accessible publications, and cannot guarantee every internet tender.

Hosting and rollout

The planned address is **tenders.pumpsystemsafrika.com**. The main company website can remain on its current host; the tender application may be hosted separately. Confirm the domain/DNS administrator, hosting capabilities, email provider and secure PRAZ connection before production rollout.

First-version acceptance

Demonstrate manual entry; PRAZ/Private sorting; Projects Manager review; pursue-to-priorities; a daily 08:00 CAT scan and Check now; strong-match emails to all staff; duplicate prevention; and reminders that continue during a source outage. Validate these with real integrations before calling the system live.

Reference: PRAZ supplier workflow - <https://www.praz.org.zw/abridged-version-e-bidding-steps-egg-system/>